



# PAPUA NEW GUINEA

POLESTAR INSIGHTS

REPORTING PERIOD: 22 JULY 2026 - 28 JULY 2026

BOTTOM LINE UP FRONT

The most serious validated development in Papua New Guinea was kama sda student found dead; police investigate alleged murder on 22 July 2026. The period also brought PNG's East New Britain province devastated by unfolding maritime tragedy and morobe police investigate wilful murder of gold buyer in wau-waria in Morobe. During the reporting period, violent crime and maritime events made up most of the reporting, and Morobe carried a disproportionate share of it. Reporting volume fell compared with the previous period. For operations, the immediate significance is that the lead event bears directly on staff safety and journey planning around the affected area.

TOP 3 DEVELOPMENTS

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| <div><div><div><div><div><div></div><div><b>KAMA SDA STUDENT FOUND DEAD; POLICE INVESTIGATE ALLEGED MURDER:</b></div></div></div><div><div>Homicide / violent crime · Reported 22 Jul 2026 · EMTV (PNG)</div><div>For operators, an event of this kind bears directly on staff safety and journey planning around the affected area.</div></div></div></div></div>                | <div><div>HIGH</div></div> |
| <div><div><div><div><div><div></div><div><b>PNG's East New Britain province devastated by unfolding maritime tragedy</b></div></div></div><div><div>Maritime / port · Reported 22 Jul 2026 · RNZ Pacific</div><div>For operators, an event of this kind affects port calls and sea freight through the waters or ports involved.</div></div></div></div></div>                    | <div><div>LOW</div></div>  |
| <div><div><div><div><div><div></div><div><b>MOROBE POLICE INVESTIGATE WILFUL MURDER OF GOLD BUYER IN WAU-WARIA</b></div></div></div><div><div>Homicide / violent crime · Morobe · Reported 28 Jul 2026 · PNG Haus Bung</div><div>For operators, an event of this kind bears directly on staff safety and journey planning around the affected area.</div></div></div></div></div> | <div><div>LOW</div></div>  |

CURRENT SITUATION

Security incidents in Papua New Guinea during the reporting period were concentrated in Morobe, with the remainder unlocated. Violent crime and maritime were the principal concerns. Morobe generated repeat reporting within the period, so the pressure there is sustained rather than a one-off. The incidents remain localised, and movement decisions should be based on current conditions at the destination.

OTHER OPERATIONAL DISRUPTION

Operational disruption to transport, utilities or connectivity was reported, including aviation, maritime and other security, reported across several areas without a single focus. The most serious reported was Reconnecting Rural and remote Papua New Guinea, assessed as Low severity. Reporting of this activity eased against the previous week. This reporting is most relevant to transport, power, communications and the operations that depend on them. Disruption of this kind can interrupt operations, logistics and connectivity.

#### CRIME, THEFT & ROBBERY

Crime, theft and violent incidents were reported, including violent crime and theft, concentrated in Morobe. The most serious reported was Community education and grief counselling key to end sorcery-related violence in PNG, Catholic priest says, assessed as High severity. Reporting of this activity eased against the previous week. This reporting is most relevant to staff safety, premises, vehicles and the secure movement of cash and assets. Incidents of this kind threaten staff, premises and the movement of cash and assets.

#### GOVERNANCE & REGULATORY

Policing, regulatory and governance-related activity was reported, including policing operation, reported across several areas without a single focus. The most serious reported was Operation 'Rausim Illegal Gambling' nets 65 arrests in WHP and Jiwaka, assessed as Moderate severity. Reporting of this activity eased against the previous week. This reporting is most relevant to permits, compliance, checkpoints and freedom of movement. Regulatory, policing and governance friction can affect compliance, permits and freedom of movement.

## OPERATIONAL IMPACT

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No fresh incident-driven business impact was identified this period. Standing exposures - urban crime, Highlands tribal violence, and intermittent road, power and connectivity disruption - continue to apply.

## RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

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#### MOVEMENT

- Confirm current route conditions before travel into affected districts.
- Avoid non-essential after-hours movement where recent violence has occurred.

#### SITE SECURITY

- Review access arrangements at sites close to reported incidents.
- Confirm after-hours escalation procedures with guards and site managers.
- Check that emergency contacts and reporting lines remain current.

#### STAFF AWARENESS

- Reinforce immediate reporting of roadblocks, violence or police activity.
- Share only verified areas to avoid.

#### TRANSPORT AND LOGISTICS

- Confirm airport, port and road status before affected movements.
- Check supplier and delivery routes where disruption is reported.
- Hold alternatives for time-sensitive journeys.

## OUTLOOK: NEXT SEVEN DAYS

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Violent crime is likely to remain the main concern during the next seven days. Morobe saw repeat reporting within the period and is the most likely setting for renewed incidents. Reporting volume fell compared with the previous period. The coming days should be judged against that direction rather than any single event.

#### ESCALATION INDICATORS

- Further casualty-bearing or higher-severity violence close to staffed premises
- Spread of incidents beyond Lae / Morobe and Port Moresby / National Capital District into new districts
- Flashpoints around paydays, court rulings, election cycles and tribal-payback events

## POLESTAR VIEW

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This period the reporting that carried real weight was violent crime; the rest of the week's items were routine by comparison. Weighed together, the week's reporting bears most on both movement planning and the safety of staff and premises, and that is where checks will pay off first. On assessment, the risk is localised, and it is best managed through location-specific decisions rather than country-wide measures. The key judgement is that violent crime drives the current concern, while other categories contributed limited, separate disruption. Businesses should prioritise verified route and site information for Morobe over broad precautionary measures.

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